The backdrop, Empire Mills compound, Lower Parel, Mumbai, became the perfect companion for a legacy brand. Once the beating heart of Girangaon, the historic mill village's soul remains etched into its surviving brick and ironwork. It is exactly here, inside a magnificent former Victorian warehouse, that Dubai-based design studio Roar unveiled a spectacular new showroom for Jaipur Rugs. Executed in a hyper-paced seven months, Roar's founder and creative director, Pallavi Dean, brought a 'done yesterday' Dubai work ethic to execute a lesson in adaptive reuse. Instead of fighting the historic layout, the original Victorian steel structure, pitched timber roof and high clerestory windows were meticulously refurbished and left completely untouched. By allowing the original envelope to do the heavy lifting, Dean created a calm, monolithic backdrop where heritage and modernity live in perfect architectural tension.



Rhythm in Repose

The true genius of the project lies in its interior framework. "Weaving is entirely about rhythm and repetition," says Dean. "One loop, one pile is eventually transported into a giant carpet. We played with that exact logic of fractal geometry, repeating it at small, medium and large scales." What began as a practical solution to conceal unsightly structural columns evolved into the definitive design language of the store. A series of stepped, cuboid volumes rise throughout the interior. They act interchangeably as sculptural platforms to elevate a single masterpiece, stretch into gallery walls, or transform into reflective installations. This fractal scaling moves beautifully from the micro level of a single loop, up to the medium scale of the store's custom lighting and finally to the macro scale of the massive cuboid structures.

SHOW AND TELL

The vast gallery space showcases Jaipur Rugs pieces hung like monumental works of art (far left); a detailed look at the floor-to-ceiling coral rope installations that mimic the tense, vertical alignment of traditional loom threads (left)